- **T. Boveri (1902)** supported the idea that the chromosomes contain genetic determiners, and he was largely responsible for developing the chromosomal theory of inheritance.
- **W.S. Sutton (1902),** a young American student independently recognized a parallelism (similarity) between the behaviour of chromosomes and Mendelian factors during gamete formation.

Sutton and **Boveri (1903)** independently proposed the chromosome theory of inheritance. Sutton united the knowledge of chromosomal segregation with Mendelian principles and called it chromosomal theory of inheritance.

3.1.2 Salient features of the Chromosomal theory of inheritance

- Somatic cells of organisms are derived from the zygote by repeated cell division (mitosis). These consist of two identical sets of chromosomes. One set is received from female parent (maternal) and the other from male parent (paternal). These two chromosomes constitute the homologous pair.
- Chromosomes retain their structural uniqueness and individuality throughout the life cycle of an organism.
- Each chromosome carries specific determiners or Mendelian factors which are now termed as genes.
- The behaviour of chromosomes during the gamete formation (meiosis) provides evidence to the fact that genes or factors are located on chromosomes.

3.1.4 Comparison between gene and chromosome behaviour

Around twentieth century cytologists established that, generally the total number of chromosomes is constant in all cells of a species. A diploid eukaryotic cell has two haploid sets of chromosomes, one set from each parent. All somatic cells of an organism carry the same genetic complement. The behaviour of chromosomes during meiosis not only explains Mendel's principles but leads to new and different approaches to study about heredity.

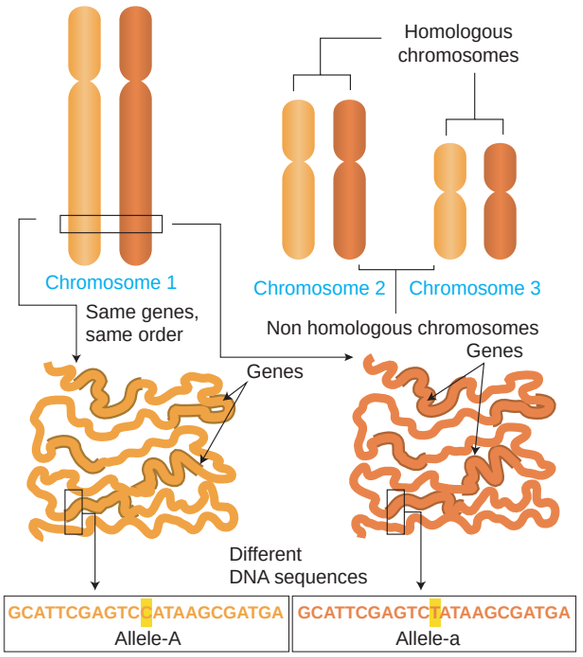


Figure 3.2: Comparison of chromosome and gene behaviour

Mendelian factors	Chromosomes behaviour
1. Alleles of a factor occur in pair	Chromosomes occur in pairs
2. Similar or dissimilar alleles of a factor separate during the gamete formation	The homologous chromosomes separate during meiosis
3. Mendelian factors can assort independently	The paired chromosomes can separate independently during meiosis but the linked genes in the same chromosome normally do not assort independently.

Table 3.1: Parallelism between Mendelian factors and chromosomal behaviour.

Thomas Hunt Morgan (1933) received Nobel Prize in Physiology or Medicine for his discoveries concerning the role played by chromosomes in heredity.



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